BEGINNER PATH | WORKBOOK

AI Foundations & Everyday Productivity

Print it, write in it, keep it. Your lab notes, practice and reflections for all 20 days.

About me

Name: _____ Phone: _____

What I do now: _____

Why I joined this course:

My three goals for these four weeks:

Tools and accounts checklist

Tool	Account created	2-step on	Notes
Assistant 1			
Assistant 2			
Canva			
Google account			
WhatsApp Business			

How to use this workbook

Each day has two pages. Page one is for the lab: write your prompts, record results and notes. Page two is for review: questions, reflection and homework. Use a pen. Write messy notes: this is your thinking space.

Progress tracker

Week	Deliverable	Done
Week 1	Personal AI toolkit page and prompt notebook	
Week 2	Study/work plan, research summary and productivity workflow	
Week 3	Portfolio of 5 designed pieces (poster, social set, CV, product listing, short video script)	
Week 4	Custom AI assistant, mini project, portfolio and demo day presentation	

Week 1: Meet AI: Foundations and First Prompts

Goal: Remove fear, understand how AI works at a high level, set up tools, and write good prompts.

Deliverable: Personal AI toolkit page and prompt notebook

My target for this week:

Weekly checklist

[ ] Day 1: What is AI? Setup clinic

[ ] Day 2: The R-T-C-F prompt framework

[ ] Day 3: Safe and responsible AI

[ ] Day 4: AI as your writing partner

[ ] Day 5: Lab day: Personal AI Toolkit

At the end of the week I will show:

Day 1: What is AI? Setup clinic

Objectives

[ ] Explain in your own words what AI is and what generative AI does

[ ] Name three things AI does well and three things it does badly

[ ] Create and secure accounts for at least two AI assistants

[ ] Ask the same question to two assistants and compare the answers

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Open two AI assistants in your browser or app and create free accounts (a trainer will help with any problems)

[ ] **Step 2.** Turn on two-step verification for your email and for one AI account

[ ] **Step 3.** Type: 'Explain what a mobile money agent does in 5 sentences for a 12-year-old.' Copy the answer from Assistant A into your notebook

[ ] **Step 4.** Ask Assistant B exactly the same question and copy its answer

[ ] **Step 5.** Compare the answers: which is clearer, which is longer, which has anything wrong or missing?

[ ] **Step 6.** Play 'AI or Not?': look at 10 examples of text and pictures and vote whether AI made them. Discuss the clues you used

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 1 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What does 'generative' AI do?

Q2. Why can an AI answer sound right but be wrong?

Q3. Name one thing you must never type into an AI tool.

Q4. What is a hallucination?

Q5. Why compare two assistants?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Generative AI	
Prompt	
Hallucination	
Training data	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Ask AI 3 questions about your own life or work; write what was useful and what was wrong.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 2: The R-T-C-F prompt framework

Objectives

[ ] Write prompts using Role, Task, Context and Format

[ ] Turn a vague prompt into a specific one

[ ] Improve an answer using follow-up instructions

[ ] Build a small personal library of reusable prompts

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Write a weak prompt about a real need (for example: 'help me with my business')

[ ] **Step 2.** Rewrite it using R, T, C and F; label each part with a colour or underline

[ ] **Step 3.** Run both versions and paste the answers side by side

[ ] **Step 4.** Ask three follow-ups to improve the better answer (shorter, simpler, add an example)

[ ] **Step 5.** Join the relay: your team receives a weak prompt, improves it, and the class votes on the best result

[ ] **Step 6.** Save your five best prompts in your notebook with [brackets] for the changing parts

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 2 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What do the letters R-T-C-F stand for?

Q2. Why is context important?

Q3. Give two follow-up instructions that improve an answer.

Q4. What is the benefit of square brackets in saved prompts?

Q5. What question reveals hidden guesses?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
R-T-C-F	
Iteration	
Context	
Template	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Build 5 reusable prompts for your own work in the prompt notebook.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 3: Safe and responsible AI

Objectives

[ ] Identify information you must never share with AI

[ ] Fact-check an AI answer in three steps

[ ] Recognise common scams, fake job offers and deepfakes

[ ] Write your personal Safe AI Rules

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** In pairs, review a document containing fake private details and replace each with a safe placeholder

[ ] **Step 2.** Take a short AI answer prepared by the trainer; mark every claim that needs checking

[ ] **Step 3.** Verify five claims using official websites or other trusted sources and write down what was wrong

[ ] **Step 4.** Study 6 example messages (job offer, family emergency, investment, prize, bank alert, voice note) and decide: real or scam?

[ ] **Step 5.** Discuss deepfake clues: odd blinking, mismatched lip movement, strange hands, background glitches, urgent requests

[ ] **Step 6.** Write your own list of seven Safe AI Rules and sign it

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 3 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Give two things you must never type into an AI tool.

Q2. What are the three steps to fact-check?

Q3. What should you do if a relative asks for urgent money by voice note?

Q4. Why can AI show bias?

Q5. Who is responsible for work you submit using AI?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Deepfake	
Phishing	
Bias	
Verification	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Write your own 'Safe AI Rules' list (7 rules) and share with a family member.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 4: AI as your writing partner

Objectives

[ ] Use AI to draft emails, letters and messages in the right tone

[ ] Edit and improve your own writing without losing your voice

[ ] Rewrite one message for different audiences

[ ] Check and correct AI-written text before sending

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Write a one-paragraph brief for a formal request (for example to a landlord or school office)

[ ] **Step 2.** Generate the draft, then give three editing instructions and compare versions

[ ] **Step 3.** Create a friendly follow-up message to the same person and a firm complaint letter about a different issue

[ ] **Step 4.** Rewrite each message in three tones: formal, friendly, urgent. Mark your favourite

[ ] **Step 5.** Paste a sample of your own writing and ask the AI to rewrite a message in your style

[ ] **Step 6.** Pair review: read each other's final message aloud and check facts, spelling and tone

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 4 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What four steps make a good writing workflow?

Q2. How can you keep your own voice?

Q3. What should you check before sending?

Q4. Why ask for several tones?

Q5. What can AI proofreading explain?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Tone	
Draft	
Proofread	
Style sample	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Draft a real message you need to send this week and send it.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 5: Lab day: Personal AI Toolkit

Objectives

[ ] Choose the right AI tool for the right job

[ ] Organise your prompts and chats so you can find them

[ ] Complete a one-page personal AI toolkit

[ ] Present what you have learned to a partner

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** List five real tasks you do in a normal week and mark which could involve AI

[ ] **Step 2.** Test two tasks on two tools; record which tool you prefer and why

[ ] **Step 3.** Organise your prompt notebook into categories and give each prompt a short name

[ ] **Step 4.** Create your one-page Personal AI Toolkit (tools, ten prompts, safe rules, three target tasks)

[ ] **Step 5.** Swap with a partner and give feedback using strength, question, idea

[ ] **Step 6.** Prepare a 60-second talk: 'What AI did for me this week' using real examples

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 5 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. How do you choose a tool?

Q2. Why keep a prompt master document?

Q3. What goes in your toolkit?

Q4. What are the three parts of good peer feedback?

Q5. Why back up your work?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Toolkit	
Workflow	
Peer review	
Backup	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Prepare 60-second 'What AI did for me this week' talk.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Week 2: AI for Everyday Productivity

Goal: Use AI to research, summarize, plan, learn and work faster in real life.

Deliverable: Study/work plan, research summary and productivity workflow

My target for this week:

Weekly checklist

[ ] Day 6: Research and summarizing

[ ] Day 7: Voice, photos and AI on your phone

[ ] Day 8: AI for learning and study

[ ] Day 9: Spreadsheets and documents with AI

[ ] Day 10: Lab day: Plan Your Life Project

At the end of the week I will show:

Day 6: Research and summarizing

Objectives

[ ] Ask research questions that get useful answers

[ ] Summarize long documents into a clear one-page brief

[ ] Check sources before relying on information

[ ] Compare options and write a pros-and-cons brief

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Choose a real question (a course, loan, device, business idea, health service) and ask a broad overview prompt

[ ] **Step 2.** Write five follow-up questions that narrow the topic and run them

[ ] **Step 3.** Summarize three documents (a news article, a policy page and a product manual) into a 5-bullet summary each

[ ] **Step 4.** Ask for sources and open each link; mark them verified, wrong or unreachable

[ ] **Step 5.** Request a pros-and-cons table with costs and risks for two options

[ ] **Step 6.** Combine everything into a one-page brief with sources listed and share it with a partner

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 6 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Why start broad and then narrow?

Q2. What should you do with a source the AI gives?

Q3. Name two formats for a summary.

Q4. Which decisions need a professional?

Q5. Why tell the AI your purpose?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Source	
Summary	
Verify	
Brief	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Research a decision you face (course, loan, device) and write a pros and cons brief.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 7: Voice, photos and AI on your phone

Objectives

[ ] Dictate notes and messages by voice and tidy them up with AI

[ ] Use the phone camera so AI can read, describe and explain what you photograph

[ ] Set up voice and read-aloud tools that make AI easier to use

[ ] Know what not to photograph or say aloud to an AI tool

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Open an AI app or the keyboard microphone and dictate a 30-second message about your day; read the transcript and mark the mistakes

[ ] **Step 2.** Ask the AI to turn your rough dictation into a clear message under 80 words, then into a three-item to-do list

[ ] **Step 3.** Photograph a safe item (a product label, a poster or a page from a school book) and ask the AI to explain it in simple words

[ ] **Step 4.** Ask the AI three follow-up questions about the photo, including one it cannot answer, and note how it responds

[ ] **Step 5.** In pairs, review each other's photos and check that nothing private (faces, numbers, addresses) is visible

[ ] **Step 6.** Set up one accessibility feature on your phone (larger text, read aloud, or voice control) and use it for the rest of the session

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 7 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Why read dictated text before sending it?

Q2. Name one good use of voice with AI.

Q3. What makes a photo easier for AI to read?

Q4. Give two things you must not photograph for an AI tool.

Q5. How can phones help people who find typing hard?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Dictation	
Voice mode	
Accessibility	
Transcript	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Use voice or the camera with AI once a day for three days and note what worked.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 8: AI for learning and study

Objectives

[ ] Use AI as a personal tutor that explains and tests you

[ ] Create a study plan, flashcards and a quiz

[ ] Study honestly and avoid copying

[ ] Track your learning progress for three days

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Pick any topic you really need (a KCSE subject, a trade, a certificate, a language)

[ ] **Step 2.** Ask the AI to explain it simply, then explain it back and get corrections

[ ] **Step 3.** Generate a 7-day study plan with daily tasks that fit your real schedule

[ ] **Step 4.** Create 10 flashcards and a 10-question quiz; take the quiz without help

[ ] **Step 5.** Mark your quiz and ask the AI to explain every mistake in a new way

[ ] **Step 6.** Start a three-day tracker: time studied, topics covered, quiz score each day

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 8 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Why explain a topic back to the AI?

Q2. What is active recall?

Q3. What should a study plan include?

Q4. Is submitting AI work as your own always allowed?

Q5. Why ask for steps in maths?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Active recall	
Flashcard	
Study plan	
Analogy	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Follow your study plan for 3 days and track results.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 9: Spreadsheets and documents with AI

Objectives

[ ] Use AI to write spreadsheet formulas and clean data

[ ] Build a budget sheet with a chart

[ ] Turn meeting notes into action lists

[ ] Create an invoice or schedule template

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Open a new spreadsheet and ask AI to suggest budget categories for your situation

[ ] **Step 2.** Enter sample figures and ask AI for the formulas for totals and balance; check them manually

[ ] **Step 3.** Add a chart and write a one-sentence summary of what it shows

[ ] **Step 4.** Clean a messy list of 20 names or products using sort, filter and remove duplicates

[ ] **Step 5.** Paste fake meeting notes and ask for actions with owners and deadlines

[ ] **Step 6.** Create an invoice or weekly schedule template and save it in a folder named Templates

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 9 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. How should you describe a formula request?

Q2. Why test formulas with simple numbers?

Q3. What four groups are in a basic budget?

Q4. Why work on a copy of data?

Q5. What should meeting actions include?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Formula	
Cell	
Template	
Duplicate	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Track real spending for 3 days in your sheet.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 10: Lab day: Plan Your Life Project

Objectives

[ ] Combine several AI tools into one workflow

[ ] Audit five tasks for time saved with AI

[ ] Build a weekly planner and routine

[ ] Give a two-minute demo of your workflow

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** List 10 recurring tasks in your week and circle five to test

[ ] **Step 2.** Record the time each takes without AI

[ ] **Step 3.** Complete each with AI and record new time and a quality score

[ ] **Step 4.** Build a weekly planner with AI: tasks, deadlines and a daily routine that fits your life

[ ] **Step 5.** Draw your workflow on one page: input, AI step, check, output

[ ] **Step 6.** Give a two-minute demo to a partner or the class and take one question

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 10 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Name one good and one poor task for AI.

Q2. What should the time audit include?

Q3. What are the four parts of a workflow?

Q4. What goes in a two-minute demo?

Q5. What do you do if AI lowers quality?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Workflow	
Audit	
Routine	
Demo	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Prepare a 2-minute demo of your workflow.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Week 3: Create and Earn: Content, Design and Small Business

Goal: Make professional content and business materials and discover simple ways to earn.

Deliverable: Portfolio of 5 designed pieces (poster, social set, CV, product listing, short video script)

My target for this week:

Weekly checklist

[ ] Day 11: AI image and design basics

[ ] Day 12: Social media content

[ ] Day 13: CVs, cover letters and job search

[ ] Day 14: AI for small business

[ ] Day 15: Lab day: Build a Business-in-a-Box

At the end of the week I will show:

Day 11: AI image and design basics

Objectives

[ ] Write image prompts that describe subject, style and mood

[ ] Design a poster and social media graphic in Canva

[ ] Use background removal, resizing and brand colours

[ ] Understand copyright and ethics for AI images

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Choose a real or imaginary Ruiru business and write its one-sentence message

[ ] **Step 2.** Write three image prompts, generate versions, and pick the best

[ ] **Step 3.** Open Canva, select an A4 poster size and build the poster using the four design rules

[ ] **Step 4.** Resize the poster into a social media square and a WhatsApp status

[ ] **Step 5.** Remove the background from one image and test two colour combinations for contrast

[ ] **Step 6.** Proofread all text and phone numbers, export a PDF and a PNG, and show a partner

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 11 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What are four parts of an image prompt?

Q2. What are the four design basics?

Q3. Which file format suits printing?

Q4. Why avoid text in AI images?

Q5. Name one ethical rule for AI images.

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Hierarchy	
Contrast	
Brand kit	
Licence	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Redesign a flyer you have seen locally and compare.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 12: Social media content

Objectives

[ ] Generate content ideas, captions and hashtags

[ ] Plan a two-week content calendar

[ ] Write short video scripts

[ ] Write posts in a friendly voice for local audiences

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Describe a business or group and choose three content pillars

[ ] **Step 2.** Generate 20 ideas per pillar and shortlist 10 in total

[ ] **Step 3.** Write captions for six posts with a call to action each

[ ] **Step 4.** Build a two-week calendar table with date, pillar, idea, format and caption

[ ] **Step 5.** Write one 30-second video script and rehearse it

[ ] **Step 6.** Peer review: check tone, spelling, honesty of claims and contact information

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 12 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What is a content pillar?

Q2. What are the parts of a caption?

Q3. Why batch content?

Q4. What is a good video structure?

Q5. What should you review after two weeks?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Content pillar	
Call to action	
Batching	
Engagement	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Post 3 pieces for a real page (yours or a friend's).

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 13: CVs, cover letters and job search

Objectives

[ ] Tailor a CV to a specific job advert

[ ] Write a clear cover letter and LinkedIn summary

[ ] Practise interviews with AI as the interviewer

[ ] Apply for a real opportunity with confidence

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Choose a real job advert and underline the top five requirements

[ ] **Step 2.** Write your honest experience and achievements in plain notes

[ ] **Step 3.** Ask AI to build a one-page CV targeted to the advert, then correct anything untrue or unclear

[ ] **Step 4.** Produce a 250-word cover letter and a short LinkedIn summary

[ ] **Step 5.** Run a 10-question mock interview and write the feedback you received

[ ] **Step 6.** Use STAR to prepare three stories from your own life and practise them aloud with a partner

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 13 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Why tailor a CV?

Q2. What three questions does a cover letter answer?

Q3. What does STAR stand for?

Q4. Should you pay to get an interview?

Q5. Why must you avoid false claims?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
CV	
STAR	
Referee	
Cover letter	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Apply to one real opportunity using your new CV.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 14: AI for small business

Objectives

[ ] Write product descriptions and a WhatsApp Business catalogue

[ ] Create quick replies and customer messages

[ ] Do simple market and competitor research

[ ] Plan a basic promotion

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Choose a product or service and write five facts about it

[ ] **Step 2.** Generate a short honest description for the product and three alternatives

[ ] **Step 3.** Draft a WhatsApp Business greeting, away message and five quick replies

[ ] **Step 4.** Do research: list customer needs and three competitors, then validate one point by asking a real person

[ ] **Step 5.** Create a weekend promotion message and test it on five contacts

[ ] **Step 6.** Record the feedback and improve the message

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 14 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What should a product description include?

Q2. What are quick replies for?

Q3. How do you check AI market research?

Q4. What three parts make a promotion?

Q5. Why protect customer numbers?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Catalogue	
Quick reply	
Competitor	
Promotion	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Test your promotion message with 5 real contacts.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 15: Lab day: Build a Business-in-a-Box

Objectives

[ ] Combine branding, content and customer messages into one pack

[ ] Cost and price a service or product

[ ] Create a one-page business plan summary

[ ] Deliver a 90-second pitch

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Define customer, problem and one-sentence promise for your business idea

[ ] **Step 2.** Pick a name, colours and write a short slogan; test on three people

[ ] **Step 3.** Create a poster, five social posts and a price list using the tools learned this week

[ ] **Step 4.** Build a cost table with real prices and calculate a profit-based price

[ ] **Step 5.** Write the one-page plan and check every number

[ ] **Step 6.** Practise and deliver a 90-second pitch and collect feedback

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 15 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What are the three starter questions?

Q2. What costs belong in pricing?

Q3. What goes on a one-page plan?

Q4. What are the four parts of a pitch?

Q5. Why test names with real people?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Pitch	
Profit	
Slogan	
Business plan	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Pitch practice: 90 seconds.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Week 4: Apply: Build Your Own AI Assistant and Demo Day

Goal: Customize an AI assistant, complete a real project and present with confidence.

Deliverable: Custom AI assistant, mini project, portfolio and demo day presentation

My target for this week:

Weekly checklist

[ ] Day 16: Your custom AI assistant

[ ] Day 17: Mini project sprint 1: plan and build

[ ] Day 18: Mini project sprint 2: improve and test

[ ] Day 19: Portfolio and next steps

[ ] Day 20: Demo Day and graduation

At the end of the week I will show:

Day 16: Your custom AI assistant

Objectives

[ ] Explain what a custom AI assistant is

[ ] Write clear instructions: purpose, tone, rules and examples

[ ] Add your own knowledge notes to the assistant

[ ] Test and improve the assistant with real questions

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Choose a real need and write one sentence describing the assistant's job

[ ] **Step 2.** Draft its instructions using purpose, audience, tone, rules and two examples

[ ] **Step 3.** Create the assistant in your chosen tool and add a short knowledge document

[ ] **Step 4.** Ask it ten normal questions and five difficult ones; record results in a table

[ ] **Step 5.** Improve the instructions to fix the three biggest problems

[ ] **Step 6.** Ask a classmate to test it for five minutes and note what surprised them

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 16 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What is a custom assistant?

Q2. List the five parts of good instructions.

Q3. What should it do when it does not know?

Q4. Why test with tricky questions?

Q5. Why keep knowledge updated?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Custom instructions	
Knowledge file	
Edge case	
Version	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Collect 5 test conversations and note improvements.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 17: Mini project sprint 1: plan and build

Objectives

[ ] Choose a real problem and define the user

[ ] Complete a project canvas

[ ] Build the first working version

[ ] Check progress with mentors at regular intervals

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Write three possible problems and choose one using the real, small, measurable test

[ ] **Step 2.** Complete the project canvas on paper or in a document

[ ] **Step 3.** List the five tasks needed to build the first version

[ ] **Step 4.** Build the core of the project; stop for mentor check-ins every 30 minutes

[ ] **Step 5.** Write down what is working and what is not

[ ] **Step 6.** Ask one real user to try it and note their reaction

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 17 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. What makes a good project?

Q2. What does a canvas include?

Q3. What should the first version be?

Q4. When should you ask for help?

Q5. What do you report at check-ins?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Canvas	
Scope	
Prototype	
Blocker	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Gather feedback from one real user.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 18: Mini project sprint 2: improve and test

Objectives

[ ] Gather feedback from real users and act on it

[ ] Use a quality checklist for accuracy, tone, safety and usefulness

[ ] Improve your project in focused rounds

[ ] Prepare your demo script

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Ask three classmates to test your project and record their comments in a table

[ ] **Step 2.** Score your project on accuracy, tone, safety and usefulness

[ ] **Step 3.** Rank the problems and fix the top three

[ ] **Step 4.** Test again with one new person

[ ] **Step 5.** Write a three-minute demo script and prepare backup screenshots

[ ] **Step 6.** Rehearse your demo twice and ask for timing feedback

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 18 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. Why not help during user testing?

Q2. What four things are on the quality checklist?

Q3. How many problems do you fix per round?

Q4. What should a backup for a demo be?

Q5. How long should a demo script be?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Feedback	
Iteration	
Checklist	
Rehearsal	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Prepare slides or a demo script.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 19: Portfolio and next steps

Objectives

[ ] Assemble a portfolio of your best work

[ ] Write short descriptions of each piece

[ ] Describe your new skills on a CV and LinkedIn

[ ] Choose your next learning steps

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** List everything you have made and select the best eight

[ ] **Step 2.** Fix errors and remove private information from each piece

[ ] **Step 3.** Write a four-line description for each item

[ ] **Step 4.** Organise the pieces in one folder or a simple Canva presentation

[ ] **Step 5.** Update your CV and LinkedIn with a skills line and two examples

[ ] **Step 6.** Give feedback to two classmates on their portfolios and rehearse your demo

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 19 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. How many pieces make a good portfolio here?

Q2. What should each description include?

Q3. Why give examples instead of tool lists?

Q4. What must you remove before sharing?

Q5. What is the best way to remember what you learned?

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Portfolio	
Case study	
Skills summary	
Community	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Rehearse your demo.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Day 20: Demo Day and graduation

Objectives

[ ] Present a three-minute demo with confidence

[ ] Answer questions honestly and calmly

[ ] Give kind, useful feedback to others

[ ] Celebrate and plan your next steps

Warm-up: one thing I tried since last class

Lab steps: tick each step and write notes

[ ] **Step 1.** Do a final technical check of your demo and backup

[ ] **Step 2.** Present your three-minute demo to the audience

[ ] **Step 3.** Answer at least two questions from the audience

[ ] **Step 4.** Give feedback to two other presenters using strength, question, idea

[ ] **Step 5.** Complete the reflection and course feedback forms

[ ] **Step 6.** Set a personal 30-day goal and share it with a partner

My prompts and results

My prompt (write it out)	Result (1-5)	What I would change

Day 20 review

Check your understanding

Answer in your own words, then compare with your notes.

Q1. How should a demo start?

Q2. What do you say if you do not know an answer?

Q3. What are the parts of kind feedback?

Q4. Why complete a reflection?

Q5. Name one next step after the course.

Words I learned today (write the meaning in your own words)

Word	My meaning
Demo	
Reflection	
Accountability	
Graduation	

Reflection

Today I am proud that:

The hardest part was:

One thing I will use this week:

Homework / challenge

Share your project and keep learning in the workspace.

Done? [ ] How it went:

Final project plan

Mini project canvas

Question	My answer
Who is the user?	
What problem do they have?	
How will AI help?	
What will I produce?	
What could go wrong?	
How will I know it works?	

Prompt notebook

Write your best prompts here with [brackets] for the parts that change.

Name	Prompt	Works? (1-5)

Feedback log

Record feedback from classmates and mentors.

From	Strength	Question	Idea

Course reflection and next steps

What I can do now that I could not do before:

My proudest piece of work and why:

What I will do in the next 30 days:

How I will help someone else learn:

Feedback for the course and trainers: